

making the minimum repayments on the others.

- Track your progress in a spreadsheet or notebook to keep you motivated.

Practising gratitude

When we're looking to improve our finances, it can be tempting to skip the softer skills and habits in favour of an increased focus on the practical and number-driven elements, but it's important not to do this. If this approach worked for everyone, there would have been no need for me to write this book in the first place – these supporting practices are the mould that holds everything else in place, so don't skim over this section.

Gratitude is a habit that will likely enhance not only your relationship with money but also trickle into other areas of your life. It's easy to be sceptical about gratitude practice, especially if a difficult relationship with money and consumerism has coloured the way that you view things. For a period of my life, I found it very difficult to feel grateful for anything I had, because I was constantly looking at what everybody else had, and feeling as if I wasn't measuring up. The comparison was making me miserable, and the growing debt that I was accruing in pursuit of perfection was making me anxious, and it didn't feel like there was an awful lot to be grateful for.